RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Individual Research Proposal

Media Trust's Impact on Political Satisfaction: India's Case

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Section A

Abstract

In an era of evolving media landscapes, understanding the relationship between press confidence and political system satisfaction is crucial for both media organizations and businesses operating in India. While extensive research exists on media trust and political attitudes, there remains a significant knowledge gap in understanding how press confidence specifically influences satisfaction with India's political system. This study examines this relationship using data from the World Values Survey Wave 7, analysing responses from Indian citizens (N=1,692) through multiple regression models. The findings demonstrate that higher levels of press confidence are associated with greater satisfaction in the political system, supporting the hypothesis that media trust plays a meaningful role in shaping political attitudes. Notably, the analysis shows that citizens' perception of having a voice in government mediates this relationship, suggesting a complex interplay between media trust and political satisfaction. These findings have important implications for media organizations' trust-building strategies, business risk assessment in the Indian market, and understanding the broader relationship between media credibility and democratic satisfaction in emerging economies.

Keywords: *Press Confidence, Political Satisfaction, Media Trust, Democratic Governance, Political Communication, Institutional Trust, Indian Media, Political System*

Introduction

In recent years, the relationship between **media trust and political satisfaction** has become increasingly critical in democratic societies, particularly in India's complex political landscape. As the world's largest democracy, India presents a unique case study where the interplay between **press confidence and political system satisfaction** carries significant implications for democratic functioning. The Indian media ecosystem, characterized by a mix of **state-influenced and independent** outlets, offers a compelling context for examining **how citizens' trust in the press shapes their broader political attitudes.**

The Indian media landscape has undergone substantial transformation since economic liberalization in the 1990s, yet **concerns about government influence over press operations** persist. Recent developments, including the concentration of media ownership and allegations of political pressure on news organizations, have raised questions about **press independence and its role in shaping public opinion.** This dynamic creates an intriguing environment to study **how citizens' confidence in the press correlates with their satisfaction with the political system.**

The significance of this research extends beyond academic interest. For businesses and organizations operating in India, understanding the relationship between media trust and political satisfaction provides crucial insights into market stability and public sentiment. Media organizations can utilize these findings to develop more effective trust-building strategies, while corporations can better assess political risk and market conditions. Furthermore, in an era of increasing digital media consumption and concerns about misinformation, understanding how press confidence influences political satisfaction becomes vital for maintaining democratic health.

This study examines the relationship between press confidence and political system satisfaction using comprehensive data from the World Values Survey Wave 7. By incorporating **key**

control variables such as political interest and perceived media bias, along with **mediating factors like citizens' perceived voice in governance and moderating variables like perceived journalistic corruption**, this research provides a nuanced understanding of how media trust shapes political attitudes in India's democratic framework.

The paper is structured as follows: First, we review existing literature on media trust and political satisfaction, identifying key theoretical frameworks and research gaps. The methodology section then details our data sources and analytical approach, followed by a comprehensive presentation of findings. The discussion section interprets these results within India's socio-political context, and finally, we conclude with implications for various stakeholders and suggestions for future research. Through this systematic analysis, we aim to contribute meaningful insights to both academic understanding and practical applications in India's media and political landscape.

Literature Review

Understanding the dynamics between trust in the media and satisfaction with the political system is vital for comprehending democratic processes. At the heart of this relationship lies the question: **does the level of confidence citizens have in the press influence their satisfaction with the functioning of their political system?** Research across various contexts sheds light on this intricate connection, with studies highlighting how media trust can shape broader political attitudes and satisfaction.

Chen, Li, and Ye (2022) provide an in-depth exploration of the role of unofficial media in China, where **government-controlled narratives dominate the official media landscape.** Their study focuses on how unofficial media platforms, often more critical and independent, can impact public trust in government and overall system confidence. They argue that **politically engaged individuals who consume unofficial media are likely to develop a more nuanced view of government policies and actions.** This engagement moderates the relationship between media trust and political satisfaction, suggesting that those exposed to diverse media sources are more critical but also more informed, potentially leading to higher satisfaction when their expectations align with the reality of governance. Their findings underline **the significance of media diversity in authoritarian contexts**, where unofficial media act as a counterbalance to state-controlled narratives, thus influencing political satisfaction differently compared to more open societies.

Meng and Zhou (2022) examine the effects of news media on political trust within the framework of political values. They posit that individuals with strong democratic values are more receptive to the influence of media, particularly in environments where the press is free to critique and scrutinize the government. Their research reveals that in such contexts, **media consumption reinforces political trust and satisfaction** by providing citizens with a sense of accountability and transparency in governance. This paper extends the understanding of media

trust by showing that it is not merely the content of the media but also the values held by the audience that determine how media trust translates into political satisfaction. This highlights the **role of individual predispositions in moderating the relationship between media trust and political contentment**, suggesting that media trust's impact is deeply embedded in broader cultural and political norms.

Knoll, Pitlik, and Rode (2023) add to this discourse by exploring how **TV consumption patterns interact with media freedom to influence political trust and satisfaction.** They find that in countries with high media freedom, increased consumption of TV news correlates with higher political trust and satisfaction. This relationship suggests that **media freedom amplifies the positive effects of media trust on political satisfaction** by ensuring that the information citizens receive is varied and less likely to be propagandistic. The implication is clear: in environments where the **press can operate without undue interference**, citizens are more likely to trust what they consume, leading to higher levels of satisfaction with the political system.

Ariely (2015) offers a nuanced perspective by examining **how trust in the press and political trust are conditionally related**, based on the freedom of the press in different countries. He argues that in liberal democracies with a high degree of press freedom, media trust fosters political trust and satisfaction because the press is seen as a legitimate and independent watchdog. However, in environments with **less press freedom, media trust does not necessarily translate into political trust**, as the press may be perceived as compromised or **state controlled**. This conditional relationship underscores the importance of the media environment in shaping the effectiveness of media trust in enhancing political satisfaction.

Mccorkle-Akanbi (2019) shifts the focus to younger audiences, exploring how their media consumption patterns influence trust, political efficacy, and engagement in social media activism. Her findings indicate that increased media consumption, particularly through digital

platforms, enhances political efficacy—the belief in one's ability to influence political outcomes. This heightened sense of efficacy translates into greater satisfaction with the political system, suggesting that for younger demographics, trust in the media is strongly tied to their feeling of influence in politics.

Seid (2018) investigates the concept of 'triangular trust' in Ethiopia, connecting social trust, political trust, and news media credibility. His research demonstrates that high media credibility can significantly bolster both social and political trust, thereby enhancing overall political satisfaction. This study highlights the interconnectedness of trust in different institutions and suggests **that media credibility is a crucial component of a trust ecosystem that supports democratic governance.**

Collectively, these studies showcase the complicated relationship between media trust and political satisfaction, showing that this relationship is influenced by various factors, including media type, political values, media freedom, and demographic characteristics. Understanding these dynamics is essential for media organizations and policymakers who aim to gain public trust and satisfaction with democratic processes. The insights from these studies suggest that a one-size-fits-all approach to enhancing media trust and political satisfaction is unlikely to be effective. Instead, specific strategies that consider the specific context and moderating factors are necessary for building a more politically satisfied nation.

These studies collectively highlight the critical role of 'press' trust in shaping political satisfaction. They show that while confidence in the press can enhance political satisfaction, the degree of this effect depends on various factors, including the type of media consumed, the level of media freedom, individual political values, and the broader media environment. For media organizations, this suggests the importance of fostering trust through transparency, balanced reporting, and accountability. For policymakers, it emphasizes the need to protect

press freedom as a cornerstone of democratic governance, ensuring that citizens have access to credible sources of information that encourage informed political engagement and satisfaction.

Hypothesis

“Higher levels of confidence in the press are positively associated with greater satisfaction with India's political system.”

Methodology

Source of Data

This study utilizes data from Wave 7 of the World Values Survey (WVS), conducted during 2017-2021. The WVS is a comprehensive global research initiative that examines values and beliefs across cultures through standardized questionnaires. Wave 7 comprises 290 questions covering various themes including social values, political participation, and institutional trust, making it particularly suitable for examining the relationship between press confidence and political satisfaction in India.

Sampling Methodology

The data collection in India followed WVS's rigorous sampling protocol, with face-to-face interviews conducted with 1,692 respondents. The sampling framework ensured representation of all residents aged 18 and above within private households, regardless of nationality, citizenship, or language. The WVS methodology employs a combination of probability and stratified sampling techniques to ensure national representativeness. Face-to-face interviews were conducted at respondents' residences, with responses recorded through standardized questionnaires. This method was particularly appropriate for India's diverse population, where varying literacy levels and digital access might limit the effectiveness of other survey approaches.

Independent and Dependent Variables

Independent Variable: Confidence in the Press

The primary independent variable measures public confidence in the press through a four-point scale:

- 1: None at all
- 2: Not very much
- 3: Quite a lot
- 4: A great deal

This measurement allows for clear differentiation between confidence levels while maintaining response quality

Dependent Variable: Satisfaction with the Political System in India

The dependent variable measures satisfaction with the political system on a more granular 10-point scale, where:

- 1 represents "Not at all satisfied"
- 10 represents "Completely satisfied"

The measurement captures overall satisfaction with the political system's performance rather than specific aspects.

Control, Mediating, and Moderating Variables

Control Variables

- Interest in Politics
    - Measured on a four-point scale
    - Ranges from "Not at all interested" to "Very interested"
    - Controls for varying levels of political engagement
- TV News Favors the Governing Party
    - Measures perceptions of media bias toward the governing party

    - Four-point scale assessment
    - Controls for potential influence of perceived media bias

Mediating Variable

- How much would you say the political system in your country allows people like you to have a say in what the government does?
    - Five-point scale measuring perceived influence in governmental decisions
    - Ranges from "Not at all" to "A great deal"
    - Acts as a potential pathway through which press confidence influences political satisfaction

Moderating Variable

- Perceived Corruption Among Journalists
    - Four-point scale measuring perceived corruption levels
    - Ranges from "Not at all corrupt" to "Extremely corrupt"
    - Potentially modifies the relationship between press confidence and political satisfaction

<u>Statistical Analysis</u>

The analysis employs a series of multiple regression models with increasing complexity to thoroughly examine the relationships between variables. All analyses were conducted using R statistical software (RStudio).

Base Model

The initial model examines the direct relationship between press confidence and political satisfaction:

Political Satisfaction = $\beta_0 + \beta_1$(Press Confidence) + ε

This base model showed a **significant positive correlation** ($r = 0.151$, $p < 0.001$) between press confidence and political satisfaction.

Model with Control Variables

The second model incorporates the control variables:

Political Satisfaction = $\beta_0 + \beta_1$(Press Confidence) + β_2(Political Interest) + β_3(TV News Favorability) + ε

Results showed:

- Press confidence remained significant ($\beta = 0.057$, $p < 0.001$)
- Interest in politics showed minimal effect ($\beta = 0.037$, $p = 0.182$)
- TV news favorability showed significant influence ($\beta = 0.057$, $p < 0.05$)
- The model explained approximately 2.8% of variance (Adjusted $R^2 = 0.026$)

Mediation Analysis

Two regression models were used to test mediation through citizens' say in government:

- Effect of IV on Mediator: Say in Government = $\beta_0 + \beta_1$(Political Satisfaction) + ε
    - Significant relationship found ($\beta = -0.477$, $p < 0.001$)
- Effect of Mediator on DV: Political Satisfaction = $\beta_0 + \beta_1$(Say in Government) + ε
    - Significant relationship found ($\beta = -0.095$, $p < 0.001$)
    - Model explained 4.5% of variance (Adjusted $R^2 = 0.045$)

Full Model with Moderation

Political Satisfaction = β_0 + β_1(Press Confidence) + β_2(Journalist Corruption) + β_3(Press Confidence × Journalist Corruption) + β_4(Political Interest) + β_5(TV News Favorability) + ε

Key findings:

- Significant moderation effect of perceived corruption ($\beta = 0.270$, $p < 0.001$)
- Direct effect of corruption perceptions ($\beta = -0.946$, $p < 0.001$)
- The interaction term showed significant influence on the relationship between press confidence and political satisfaction
- Final model explained 3.7% of variance (Adjusted $R^2 = 0.035$)

The progression of models allows for understanding how each variable contributes to explaining political satisfaction. While the explained variance (R^2) remains relatively modest, the **consistent significance of key variables** across models supports the robustness of the findings. All models were checked for basic assumptions of linear regression including normality of residuals, homoscedasticity, and multicollinearity.

Findings

Descriptive Statistics

The analysis begins with an examination of the key variables' distributions. The dependent variable, Political System Satisfaction, shows a mean score of 6.286 on a 10-point scale, with a median of 7, indicating a slightly positive skew in citizens' satisfaction levels. The distribution reveals notable clustering at values 7 and 8 (244 and 245 responses respectively), suggesting a generally moderate to positive satisfaction level among respondents.

The independent variable, Press Confidence, measured on a 4-point scale, demonstrates a mean of 2.431, indicating moderate levels of confidence in the press among Indian citizens. Among the control variables, Interest in Politics shows a mean of 2.528, with most respondents (667) indicating they are "somewhat interested" in politics. The distribution of TV News Favourability yields a mean of 2.123, with most respondents (596) perceiving occasional favouritism toward the governing party in television news coverage.

Model Specifications and Regression Results

Table 1: Basic Regression Results

Model	R-squared	Adjusted R-squared	F-statistic	p-value
Base Model (Confidence in Press)	0.02277	0.02214	35.98	2.477e-09
With Interest in Politics	0.02386	0.02259	18.81	8.536e-09
Full Model with Media Favor	0.02809	0.02606	13.79	7.234e-09

Table 2: Coefficient Analysis Across Models

Variable	Base Model	With Interest in Politics	Full Model
Intercept	2.430536***	2.34778***	2.20792***
Satisfaction Level	0.056047***	0.05701***	0.05807***
Interest in Politics	-	0.03171	0.03669
Media Favor Governing Party	-	-	0.05708*

Significance codes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05

Table 3: Mediator Analysis Results

Model	Variable	Estimate	Std. Error	t-value	p-value
Mediator Model 1	Intercept	7.52033	0.15772	47.683	<2e-16
(DV ~ Mediator)	Say in Government	-0.47682	0.05581	-8.544	<2e-16
Mediator Model 2	Intercept	3.16462	0.07567	41.821	<2e-16
(Mediator ~ IV)	Satisfaction Level	-0.09468	0.01108	-8.544	<2e-16

Table 4: Moderator Analysis Results

Variable	Estimate	Std. Error	t-value	p-value
Intercept	7.60312	0.63303	12.011	<2e-16
Confidence Level	-0.27799	0.20572	-1.351	0.176809
Corruption in Media	-0.94567	0.23265	-4.065	5.07e-05
Confidence:Corruption Interaction	0.27028	0.07874	3.432	0.000615

Regression Analysis and Model Progression

The analysis employed four distinct regression models, each building upon the previous to provide a comprehensive understanding of the relationship between press confidence and political satisfaction:

Model 1 (Base Model): This initial model examines the **direct relationship** between press confidence and political satisfaction, without any additional variables. The model reveals a significant positive relationship ($\beta = 0.056$, $p < 0.001$), indicating that higher levels of press confidence are associated with greater political satisfaction. Though statistically significant, this base model explains only 2.2% of the variance in political satisfaction.

Model 2 (Political Interest Model): The second model introduces Interest in Politics as a control variable. This addition maintains the significance of press confidence ($\beta = 0.057$, $p < 0.001$) while revealing a **minimal effect of political interest** ($\beta = 0.032$, $p > 0.05$). The model's explanatory power increases marginally to 2.3%, suggesting that political interest, while theoretically important, plays a lesser role in determining political satisfaction than anticipated.

Model 3 (Media Bias Model): This model incorporates TV News Favorability as an additional control variable. The results show that perceived media bias has a significant positive effect ($\beta = 0.057$, $p < 0.05$) on political satisfaction, while press confidence maintains its significant influence ($\beta = 0.058$, $p < 0.001$). The model's explanatory power increases to 2.6%, indicating that perceptions of media bias contribute meaningfully to political satisfaction.

Model 4 (Interaction Model): The final model introduces **the moderating effect of Perceived Journalist Corruption** through an interaction term with press confidence. This model reveals complex relationships: a **significant negative direct effect** of journalist corruption ($\beta = -0.946$, $p < 0.001$) and a **significant positive interaction effect** ($\beta = 0.270$, $p < 0.001$). The model explains 3.7% of the variance, representing the highest explanatory power among all models.

Primary Analysis

The progression through these models reveals several important patterns. First, the consistent significance of press confidence across all models suggests its robust relationship with political satisfaction, independent of other factors. The magnitude of this relationship remains relatively stable ($\beta \approx 0.056$-0.058) until the introduction of the interaction term.

The role of political interest proves less influential than theoretically expected, with non-significant effects across models. This finding challenges assumptions about the direct relationship between political engagement and system satisfaction. In contrast, **the significant effect of TV news favorability highlights the importance of perceived media bias in shaping political attitudes.**

The interaction model reveals particularly interesting dynamics. The strong negative effect of **perceived journalist corruption suggests that general distrust in media integrity significantly reduces political satisfaction.** However, the positive interaction term indicates that the relationship between press confidence and political satisfaction becomes stronger as perceived corruption increases. This could suggest that in contexts of high perceived

corruption, **trust in the press becomes a more crucial factor in maintaining political satisfaction.**

Mediation Analysis

The examination of citizens' say in government as a mediating variable reveals significant pathways. The effect of press confidence on citizens' perceived say in government is significant and negative ($\beta = -0.477$, $p < 0.001$), as is the effect of perceived say on political satisfaction ($\beta = -0.095$, $p < 0.001$). This suggests a complex mediation process where press confidence influences political satisfaction partially through its effect on citizens' perceived political efficacy.

Implications

These findings have several important implications. The consistent significance of press confidence across all models underscores **the fundamental role of media trust in shaping political attitudes.** However, the relatively low R-squared values across all models suggest that political satisfaction is a complex phenomenon influenced by many factors beyond those captured in this analysis.

The interaction between press confidence and perceived corruption reveals a nuanced relationship that merits careful consideration. While corruption perceptions generally decrease political satisfaction, the strengthening effect of press confidence in high-corruption contexts suggests that **maintaining media trust might be particularly crucial in challenging institutional environments.**

Finally, the significant enough role of perceived media bias, coupled with the limited effect of political interest, suggests that media-related factors may be more important than general political engagement in shaping satisfaction with the political system. This highlights the crucial role of media institutions in democratic satisfaction and stability.

Discussion and Conclusion

Interpretation of Findings

The study highlights the pivotal role of press confidence in shaping satisfaction with the political system in India. Across all models, press confidence maintained a significant positive relationship with political satisfaction, reinforcing the hypothesis that higher levels of media trust are associated with greater satisfaction in democratic governance.

Moreover, the interaction analysis revealed that in contexts of high perceived journalist corruption, trust in the press becomes even more critical for sustaining political satisfaction. This suggests that citizens may rely on trusted media as a counterbalance to institutional flaws, indicating a significant interplay between media trust and perceptions of governance integrity. The mediation analysis further showed us how citizens' perceived say in governance bridges the gap between press confidence and political satisfaction. Citizens who trust the press may feel more represented and included in the democratic process, which in turn enhances their satisfaction with the political system.

Support for Hypothesis

The hypothesis, "Higher levels of confidence in the press are positively associated with greater satisfaction with India's political system," is strongly supported by the results. The consistent statistical significance of press confidence across models lends credibility to its role in shaping political attitudes. Additionally, the findings around corruption and citizen agency emphasize the multidimensional nature of this relationship, expanding our understanding of the dynamics between media trust and political satisfaction.

Causality

While the regression models provide robust evidence of associations, causality cannot be definitively established due to the cross-sectional nature of the data. However, the theory and modelling framework suggest a likely cause-and-effect relationship, implying that trust in the press fosters perceptions of inclusion and efficacy, leading to higher political satisfaction. Future studies employing longitudinal data or experimental designs could further substantiate these causal claims.

Limitations

1. **Cross-Sectional Data**: The study's reliance on Wave 7 of the World Values Survey limits its ability to make causal inferences. Longitudinal or experimental approaches could offer deeper insights.
2. **Limited Explained Variance**: Despite significant findings, the models explain only a modest proportion of variance in political satisfaction ($R^2 < 4\%$). This suggests that other unmeasured variables, such as economic conditions or regional differences, may also play substantial roles.
3. **Potential Bias in Self-Reporting**: Respondents' perceptions of press confidence, corruption, and political satisfaction may be influenced by social desirability or recall biases.
4. **Sample Representativeness**: While the sampling methodology ensures national representation, cultural and linguistic diversity within India might lead to regional variations not fully captured in the study.

Future Research

1. **Longitudinal Studies**: Future research could employ panel data to better capture changes in media trust and political satisfaction over time, offering stronger causal evidence.
2. **Regional Variations**: Examining how regional disparities in media freedom, corruption, and political engagement affect the relationship between press confidence and political satisfaction.
3. **Role of Digital Media**: With the rise of digital platforms, exploring how trust in online versus traditional media impacts political attitudes could provide valuable insights.
4. **Expanded Mediators and Moderators**: Including variables such as economic satisfaction, educational attainment, or exposure to misinformation could enrich understanding of the pathways and contextual factors influencing political satisfaction.

Broader Implications

The findings hold significant implications for policymakers, media organizations, and businesses operating in India:

- **Policy Implications**: Enhancing press freedom and reducing perceptions of journalistic corruption can bolster democratic satisfaction.
- **Media Strategy**: Media organizations must prioritize trust-building initiatives, such as transparent fact-checking and balanced reporting, to maintain credibility.
- **Corporate Insights**: Businesses can leverage understanding of public sentiment to navigate political risks and align their strategies with societal expectations.

In conclusion, this study underscores the essential role of media trust in fostering political satisfaction within India's democratic framework. By addressing its limitations and expanding

its scope, future research can build upon these findings to further illuminate the interplay between media, governance, and citizen satisfaction.

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Appendix (R Code)

```
> wave7 <- read_excel("C:\\Users\\Tanish Chaudhary\\Downloads\\F00017091-WVS_Wave_7_India_Excel_v6.0.xlsx")
> # DV: Q252- Satisfaction with Political System
> names(wave7)[names(wave7) == "Q252: Satisfaction with the political system performance"] <-"Q252"
> satisfaction_level <- NULL
> satisfaction_level[wave7$Q252==1] <- 1 # Not at all satisfied
> satisfaction_level[wave7$Q252==2]<-2
> satisfaction_level[wave7$Q252==3]<-3
> satisfaction_level[wave7$Q252==4]<-4
> satisfaction_level[wave7$Q252==5]<- 5
> satisfaction_level[wave7$Q252==6]<-6
> satisfaction_level[wave7$Q252==7]<-7
> satisfaction_level[wave7$Q252==8]<-8
> satisfaction_level[wave7$Q252==9]<-9
> satisfaction_level[wave7$Q252==10]<-10 #completely satisfied
> table(satisfaction_level)
satisfaction_level
  1   2   3   4   5   6   7   8   9  10
133  57 101  91 157 226 244 245 151 202
> summary(satisfaction_level)
   Min. 1st Qu.  Median    Mean 3rd Qu.    Max.    NA's
  1.000   5.000   7.000   6.286   8.000  10.000      85
> names(wave7)[names(wave7) == "Q66: Confidence: The Press"] <-"Q66"
```

```
> confidence_level <- NULL
> confidence_level[wave7$Q66==-1]<- NA
> confidence_level[wave7$Q66==1]<- 4
> confidence_level[wave7$Q66==2]<- 3
> confidence_level[wave7$Q66==3]<- 2
> confidence_level[wave7$Q66==4]<- 1
> cor(confidence_level,satisfaction_level, use="pairwise")
[1] 0.1509079
> summary(lm(confidence_level ~ satisfaction_level))

Call:
lm(formula = confidence_level ~ satisfaction_level)

Residuals:
    Min      1Q  Median      3Q     Max 
-1.9910 -0.7668  0.1771  1.0090  1.5134 

Coefficients:
                   Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)    
(Intercept)        2.430536   0.063891  38.042  < 2e-16 ***
satisfaction_level 0.056047   0.009344   5.998 2.48e-09 ***
---
Signif. codes:  0 ‘***’ 0.001 ‘**’ 0.01 ‘*’ 0.05 ‘.’ 0.1 ‘ ’ 1

Residual standard error: 0.9816 on 1544 degrees of freedom
```

```
  (146 observations deleted due to missingness)

Multiple R-squared:  0.02277,	Adjusted R-squared:  0.02214

F-statistic: 35.98 on 1 and 1544 DF,  p-value: 2.477e-09


> #Confounding Variable

> names(wave7)[names(wave7) == "Q199: Interest in politics"] <-"Q199"

> interest_in_politics <- NULL

> interest_in_politics[wave7$Q199==-1]<- NA

> interest_in_politics[wave7$Q199==1]<- 1

> interest_in_politics[wave7$Q199==2]<- 2

> interest_in_politics[wave7$Q199==3]<- 3

> interest_in_politics[wave7$Q199==4]<- 4

> table(interest_in_politics)

interest_in_politics

  1   2   3   4

239 667 421 352

> summary(interest_in_politics)

   Min. 1st Qu.  Median    Mean 3rd Qu.    Max.    NA's

  1.000   2.000   2.000   2.528   3.000   4.000      13

> Controls_model <- lm(confidence_level ~ satisfaction_level + interest_in_politics)

> summary(Controls_model)


Call:

lm(formula = confidence_level ~ satisfaction_level + interest_in_politics)
```

```
Residuals:
    Min      1Q  Median      3Q     Max
-2.0447 -0.7786  0.1580  1.0123  1.5635

Coefficients:
                    Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
(Intercept)          2.34778    0.09400  24.977  < 2e-16 ***
satisfaction_level    0.05701    0.00937   6.085 1.47e-09 ***
interest_in_politics  0.03171    0.02619   1.211    0.226
---
Signif. codes:  0 ‘***’ 0.001 ‘**’ 0.01 ‘*’ 0.05 ‘.’ 0.1 ‘ ’ 1

Residual standard error: 0.9814 on 1539 degrees of freedom
  (150 observations deleted due to missingness)
Multiple R-squared:  0.02386,	Adjusted R-squared:  0.02259
F-statistic: 18.81 on 2 and 1539 DF,  p-value: 8.536e-09

> #Confounding Variable 2
> names(wave7)[names(wave7) == "Q226: How often in country's elections: TV news favors the governing party"] <-"Q226"
> media_favour_governing_party <- NULL
> media_favour_governing_party[wave7$Q226==-1]<- NA
> media_favour_governing_party[wave7$Q226==1]<- 1
> media_favour_governing_party[wave7$Q226==2]<- 2
> media_favour_governing_party[wave7$Q226==3]<- 3
```

```
> media_favour_governing_party[wave7$Q226==4]<- 4
> table(media_favour_governing_party)
media_favour_governing_party
  1   2   3   4
457 596 285 179
> summary(media_favour_governing_party)
   Min. 1st Qu.  Median    Mean 3rd Qu.    Max.    NA's
  1.000   1.000   2.000   2.123   3.000   4.000     175
> Controls_model <- lm(confidence_level ~ satisfaction_level + interest_in_politics + media_favour_governing_party)
> summary(Controls_model)

Call:
lm(formula = confidence_level ~ satisfaction_level + interest_in_politics +
    media_favour_governing_party)

Residuals:
    Min      1Q  Median      3Q     Max
-2.1270 -0.7657  0.1614  0.9668  1.6402

Coefficients:
                        Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
(Intercept)              2.20792    0.11153  19.797  < 2e-16 ***
satisfaction_level       0.05807    0.00972   5.974 2.92e-09 ***
interest_in_politics     0.03669    0.02750   1.334   0.1823
```

```
media_favour_governing_party  0.05708    0.02693   2.120   0.0342 *
---
Signif. codes:  0 ‘***’ 0.001 ‘**’ 0.01 ‘*’ 0.05 ‘.’ 0.1 ‘ ’ 1

Residual standard error: 0.9807 on 1431 degrees of freedom
  (257 observations deleted due to missingness)
Multiple R-squared:  0.02809,	Adjusted R-squared:  0.02606
F-statistic: 13.79 on 3 and 1431 DF,  p-value: 7.234e-09

> names(wave7)[names(wave7) == "Q234A: How much would you say the political system in your country allows people like you to have a say in what the government does?"] <-"Q234A"
> say_in_govt <- NULL
> say_in_govt[wave7$Q234A==-1]<- NA
> say_in_govt[wave7$Q234A==1]<- 1
> say_in_govt[wave7$Q234A==2]<- 2
> say_in_govt[wave7$Q234A==3]<- 3
> say_in_govt[wave7$Q234A==4]<- 4
> say_in_govt[wave7$Q234A==5]<- 5
> table(say_in_govt)
say_in_govt
  1   2   3   4   5
281 614 335 225 133
> summary(say_in_govt)
   Min. 1st Qu.  Median    Mean 3rd Qu.    Max.    NA's
  1.000   2.000   2.000   2.569   3.000   5.000     104
```

```
> # Regression model 1 with mediator (DV & Mediating variable)

> Mediator_model_1 <- lm(satisfaction_level~ say_in_govt, data = wave7)

> summary(Mediator_model_1)


Call:

lm(formula = satisfaction_level ~ say_in_govt, data = wave7)


Residuals:

    Min      1Q  Median      3Q     Max

-6.0435 -1.5667  0.4333  1.9101  4.8637


Coefficients:

             Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)

(Intercept)  7.52033    0.15772  47.683   <2e-16 ***

say_in_govt -0.47682    0.05581  -8.544   <2e-16 ***

---

Signif. codes:  0 ‘***’ 0.001 ‘**’ 0.01 ‘*’ 0.05 ‘.’ 0.1 ‘ ’ 1


Residual standard error: 2.586 on 1544 degrees of freedom

  (146 observations deleted due to missingness)

Multiple R-squared:  0.04514,	Adjusted R-squared:  0.04453

F-statistic:    73 on 1 and 1544 DF,  p-value: < 2.2e-16


> #Moderating variable
```

```
> names(wave7)[names(wave7) == "Q117: Involved in corruption: Journalists and media"] <-
"Q117"
> corruption_in_media <- NULL
> corruption_in_media[wave7$Q117==-1]<- NA
> corruption_in_media[wave7$Q117==1]<- 1
> corruption_in_media[wave7$Q117==2]<- 2
> corruption_in_media[wave7$Q117==3]<- 3
> corruption_in_media[wave7$Q117==4]<- 4
> table(corruption_in_media)
corruption_in_media
  1   2   3   4
193 730 391 185
> summary(corruption_in_media)
   Min. 1st Qu.  Median    Mean 3rd Qu.    Max.    NA's
  1.000   2.000   2.000   2.379   3.000   4.000     193
> Moderator_model <- lm(satisfaction_level ~ confidence_level
+  confidence_level*corruption_in_media + corruption_in_media, data = wave7)
> summary(Moderator_model)

Call:
lm(formula = satisfaction_level ~ confidence_level + confidence_level *
    corruption_in_media + corruption_in_media, data = wave7)

Residuals:
    Min      1Q  Median      3Q     Max
```

```
-6.0329 -1.6343  0.3657  2.1025  5.3764


Coefficients:
                                Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
(Intercept)                     7.60312    0.63303  12.011  < 2e-16 ***
confidence_level               -0.27799    0.20572  -1.351 0.176809
corruption_in_media            -0.94567    0.23265  -4.065 5.07e-05 ***
confidence_level:corruption_in_media  0.27028    0.07874   3.432 0.000615 ***
---
Signif. codes:  0 ‘***’ 0.001 ‘**’ 0.01 ‘*’ 0.05 ‘.’ 0.1 ‘ ’ 1


Residual standard error: 2.643 on 1418 degrees of freedom
  (270 observations deleted due to missingness)
Multiple R-squared:  0.03662,	Adjusted R-squared:  0.03459
F-statistic: 17.97 on 3 and 1418 DF,  p-value: 1.9e-11


> # Regression model 2 with mediator (Mediating Variable and IV)
> Mediator_model_2 <- lm(say_in_govt ~ satisfaction_level, data = wave7)
> summary(Mediator_model_2)


Call:
lm(formula = say_in_govt ~ satisfaction_level, data = wave7)


Residuals:
    Min      1Q  Median      3Q     Max
```

```
-2.0699 -0.7859 -0.3125  0.6875  2.7822


Coefficients:
                  Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
(Intercept)        3.16462    0.07567  41.821   <2e-16 ***
satisfaction_level -0.09468    0.01108  -8.544   <2e-16 ***
---
Signif. codes:  0 ‘***’ 0.001 ‘**’ 0.01 ‘*’ 0.05 ‘.’ 0.1 ‘ ’ 1


Residual standard error: 1.152 on 1544 degrees of freedom
  (146 observations deleted due to missingness)
Multiple R-squared:  0.04514,	Adjusted R-squared:  0.04453
F-statistic:    73 on 1 and 1544 DF,  p-value: < 2.2e-16
```

Advanced features

- Added more literature review
- Regression with 2 controls, 1 mediator, 1 moderator, with a 4 step analysis and advanced interpretation